

Tennis Stars Team Up for a Surprise Protest at the French Open!

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Have you ever felt like you weren't getting your fair share? That's how some of the world's best tennis players feel right now! At the **French Open**, stars like Aryna Sabalenka, Iga Swiatek, and Jannik Sinner decided to spend less time talking to reporters. Why? They want more **prize money** from the four biggest tournaments, called **Grand Slams**. Sabalenka, a top player from Belarus, only gave a 10-minute **news conference** instead of the usual longer one. 'We just wanted to make our point and we are **united**,' she said. '15 minutes is better than zero.' Coco Gauff, the American champion, said she was proud everyone agreed to act together. Taylor Fritz, another American star, said they did it because they 'felt ignored.' Even though tennis is an individual sport, these players showed they can work as a team. Novak Djokovic, who has won 24 **Grand Slams**, didn't join the protest but said he supports the players' side. He reminded everyone that very few tennis players actually make a living from the sport. The players hope this '**work-to-rule**' action doing only what's required will make the Grand Slam bosses listen. It's like when kids in a classroom all decide to raise their hands at once to get the teacher's attention. Will it work? We'll have to wait and see!

Word Treasure

French Open -- A famous tennis tournament held in Paris on clay courts.

Grand Slams -- The four most important tennis tournaments in the world.

news conference -- A meeting where journalists ask questions to players or officials.

united -- Standing together as a group for a common goal.

work-to-rule -- A protest where people only do exactly what their job requires, no extra effort.

prize money -- The cash that winners receive in a competition.

Background you need

The French Open, also called Roland-Garros, is one of the four Grand Slam tournaments--the biggest events in tennis. These tournaments make millions of dollars from tickets and TV, but some players say the prize money isn't shared fairly.

Only the top finishers get large amounts, while many lower-ranked players struggle to pay their coaches and travel costs. In the past, players like Novak Djokovic (who has won 24 Grand Slams, more than any other man) have called for better support for all tennis players.

Break it down

WHO: Top tennis players including Aryna Sabalenka, Iga Swiatek, Jannik Sinner, and Coco Gauff.

WHAT: They staged a protest by shortening their news conferences to demand more prize money from Grand Slam tournaments.

WHERE: At the French Open, a Grand Slam event.

WHY: Because they felt ignored and wanted to show unity to push tournament organizers to listen.

Why it matters

This protest shows that even in individual sports like tennis, players can unite to fight for fairness, just like students might work together to change a school rule.

Test what you remember

1. Which tournament did the protest take place at?
 - ☐ (A) French Open
 - ☐ (B) Wimbledon
 - ☐ (C) US Open
 - ☐ (D) Australian Open
2. What were the players demanding more of?
 - ☐ (A) Prize money
 - ☐ (B) Vacation time
 - ☐ (C) Free rackets
 - ☐ (D) More matches
3. How long was Aryna Sabalenka's news conference?
 - ☐ (A) 10 minutes
 - ☐ (B) 15 minutes
 - ☐ (C) 30 minutes
 - ☐ (D) 0 minutes
4. Who said, "We just wanted to make our point and we are united"?
 - ☐ (A) Aryna Sabalenka
 - ☐ (B) Coco Gauff
 - ☐ (C) Taylor Fritz
 - ☐ (D) Novak Djokovic
5. What is the protest action called where players do only what's required?
 - ☐ (A) Work-to-rule
 - ☐ (B) Strike
 - ☐ (C) Boycott
 - ☐ (D) Demonstration
6. Which player supported the players but did not join the protest?
 - ☐ (A) Novak Djokovic
 - ☐ (B) Aryna Sabalenka
 - ☐ (C) Coco Gauff
 - ☐ (D) Jannik Sinner

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: A 4: A 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Players who protested:** They believe Grand Slam tournaments are not sharing enough of the money, and they used a peaceful protest to be heard.
2. **Tournament organizers:** They might think that big prize money for champions is fair because star players bring in the most fans and sponsor interest.
3. **Tennis fans:** Some fans support the players wanting a fairer system, while others miss longer interviews and worry that conflicts could affect the sport's image.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):